INTRODUCTION

YOGA:

1. ORIGIN OF YOGA:

Yoga has its origins in ancient India, dating back over 5,000 years. It began as a spiritual practice in the Indus Valley, where early texts like the Vedas mentioned practices for mental clarity and physical health. Over time, it evolved through various philosophical schools, with the development of key texts such as the Bhagavad Gita and the Yoga Sutras of Patanjali. Originally focused on achieving spiritual enlightenment, yoga gradually incorporated physical postures, breathing techniques, and meditation, becoming the holistic practice, we know today.

The term "yoga" comes from the Sanskrit word "yuj," meaning "to unite" or "to yoke," reflecting the practice's goal of uniting the body, mind, and spirit. The ancient texts of the Vedas, dating back to around 1500 BCE, introduced the concepts of meditation, breath control, and rituals, laying the foundation for yoga's development. Over time, yoga evolved through the Upanishads, which focused on inner wisdom and the nature of reality, and the Bhagavad Gita, which offered practical guidance on how to live a life of righteousness and devotion. In the centuries that followed, Patanjali's Yoga Sutras (circa 200 BCE) codified the practice into an organized system, outlining the eight limbs of yoga, which included ethical guidelines, physical postures (asanas), and meditation techniques. Yoga gradually became more accessible and secular, with the physical postures and breathing exercises taking centre stage in the modern era, particularly in the 19th and 20th centuries, as it spread globally.



Fig 1. YOGA

2. HISTORY OF YOGA:

The history of yoga spans thousands of years, beginning in ancient India. It is believed to have originated around 3000 BCE, with early forms of yoga practices linked to the Indus Valley civilization, where depictions of seated figures suggest early meditation or ritualistic practices. In the centuries that followed, yoga diversified, with various schools and traditions emerging, including Hatha Yoga, which emphasized physical postures (asanas) and breathwork. The modern era saw yoga transition into a global practice, especially in the 19th and 20th centuries, when figures like Swami Vivekananda, T. Krishnamacharya, and B.K.S. Iyengar helped popularize yoga outside of India, turning it into the widely practiced physical and mental discipline we recognize today.

3. DEVELOPMENT OF YOGA:

The development of yoga has been a dynamic process that evolved over millennia. Initially, yoga focused on spiritual practices aimed at self-realization and connection with the divine, with early forms found in the ancient Vedic and Upanishadic texts. During the 19th and 20th centuries, figures like Swami Vivekananda and T. Krishnamacharya introduced yoga to the West, leading to its transformation into a widely practiced form that blends physical exercise, mental discipline, and spiritual growth. Today, yoga continues to develop in various styles, ranging from traditional practices to modern fitness-oriented approaches.



Fig.2. History and development of yoga

4. DEFINITION AND MEANING:

4.1. **DEFINITION:**

Yoga is a practice that combines physical postures, breathing exercises, and meditation to improve overall health and well-being. It helps to connect the body, mind, and spirit, promoting relaxation, strength, flexibility, and inner peace.

4.2. **MEANING:**

The word "yoga" comes from the Sanskrit word "yuj," which means "to unite" or "to join." It refers to the practice of bringing together the body, mind, and spirit to achieve balance, peace, and self-awareness.

5. DIFFERENT SCHOOLS OF YOGA:

5.1 **Hatha Yoga:** This is the physical branch of yoga, emphasizing postures (asanas) and breath control (pranayama) to prepare the body for meditation. It's a great starting point for beginners.

5.2 **Raja Yoga:** Often called the "royal path," it focuses on meditation and mind control. It emphasizes the eight-limb path outlined in the Yoga Sutras of Patanjali, which includes ethical guidelines, physical postures, breath control, and meditation.

5.3 **Karma Yoga:** Known as the path of selfless action, Karma Yoga teaches that serving others without attachment to the outcome leads to spiritual growth and liberation.

5.4 **Bhakti Yog**a: This is the path of devotion and love, focusing on developing a deep love and connection with a higher power through prayer, chanting, and surrender.

5.5 **Jnana Yoga:** Jnana Yoga is the path of knowledge and wisdom. It involves deep self-inquiry, reflection, and meditation to understand the nature of the self and the universe.

5.6 **Kundalini Yoga:** This form of yoga focuses on awakening the dormant energy (Kundalini) at the base of the spine through postures, breathwork, chanting, and meditation.

5.7 **Mantra Yoga:** This involves the repetition of sacred sounds or mantras to focus the mind and create a connection with the divine.

6. AIM AND OBJECTIVES OF YOGA:

6.1. **AIM:**

The aim of yoga is to achieve a harmonious balance between the body, mind, and spirit, leading to overall well-being, inner peace, and self-realization. It helps practitioners develop physical strength, flexibility, and health, while also cultivating mental clarity, emotional stability, and spiritual growth. Ultimately, yoga seeks to quiet the mind, increase self-awareness, and foster a deeper connection to oneself and the world around. In its highest form, yoga aims to bring about liberation (moksha) and the realization of one's true nature.

6.2. **OBJECTIVES:**

The objective of yoga is to promote holistic well-being by integrating the body, mind, and spirit. It aims to improve physical health through postures (asanas), enhance mental clarity and focus through breath control (pranayama), and achieve inner peace and self-awareness through meditation. Yoga encourages self-discipline, mindfulness, and a deeper connection to one's true nature. Ultimately, its goal is to help individuals experience balance, harmony, and spiritual growth, leading to greater contentment and liberation from suffering.



Fig.3.Aim and Objective of Yoga

7. RULES TO BE FOLLOWED DURING YOGIC PRACTICES:

7.1 **Practice on an Empty Stomach**: It's best to practice yoga either early in the morning or a few hours after eating to avoid discomfort during postures and breathing exercises.

7.2 **Consistency**: Regular practice is key to improving in yoga. Aim to practice consistently, even if it's for a short duration.

7.3 **Mindfulness and Focus**: Yoga is about connecting mind, body, and spirit. Focus on your breath and body movements, letting go of distractions to experience the full benefits of the practice.

7.4 **Avoid Overexertion**: Listen to your body and avoid pushing yourself too hard. Yoga is not about competition but about finding your own limit and gradually improving.

7.5 **Proper Breathing**: Breathing should be deep and steady, and it should align with your movements. Breath control (pranayama) is an important aspect of yoga practice.

8. MISCONCEPTIONS OF YOGA:

8.1 **Yoga is just about physical exercise**: Many people think yoga is solely about stretching and strengthening the body, but it also includes mental and spiritual practices like meditation, breath control (pranayama), and mindfulness. The physical practice is just one aspect of the broader discipline.

8.2 **Yoga is for flexible people**: Yoga is for everyone, regardless of flexibility or fitness level. The practice can be adapted to suit individual abilities, and over time, yoga can help improve flexibility, strength, and balance.

8.3 **Yoga is a religion**: While yoga has roots in spiritual traditions, it is not a religion itself. It is a practice that can complement any religious or spiritual path. Yoga is open to people of all backgrounds and beliefs.

8.4 **You need to be young and fit to do yoga**: Yoga is suitable for people of all ages and fitness levels. There are different styles and modifications that cater to beginners, seniors, and those with physical limitations.

8.5 **Yoga is only about relaxation**: While yoga does promote relaxation, it also involves strength-building, endurance, and focus. It’s a comprehensive practice that works on the body, mind, and spirit.

9. SURYANAMASKARAM:

9.1. **SURYANAMASKARAM PRAYER:**

"OmMitrayaNamaha

OmRavayNamaha

OmSuryaayaNamaha

OmBhanaveNamaha

OmKhagayaNamaha

OmPushneNamaha

OmHiranyagarbhayaNamaha

OmMarichayeNamaha

OmAdityayaNamaha

OmSavitreNamaha

OmArkayaNamaha

Om Bhaskara Aya Namaha"

9.2. **MEANING OF PRAYER:**

- **Om Mitraya Namaha** - Salutations to the friend of all, the Sun, who is a source of warmth and affection.
- **Om Ravaye Namaha** - Salutations to the radiant one, the Sun, who brings light and life.
- **Om Suryaaya Namaha** - Salutations to the Sun God, the giver of light and energy.
- **Om Bhanave Namaha** - Salutations to the one who shines with brilliance.
- **Om Khagaya Namaha** - Salutations to the one who moves across the sky.
- **Om Pushne Namaha** - Salutations to the nourisher, the Sun, who sustains life.
- **Om Hiranyagarbhaya Namaha** - Salutations to the one with a golden womb, the Sun who is the source of creation.
- **Om Marichaye Namaha** - Salutations to the one who brings light to the world.
- **Om Adityaya Namaha** - Salutations to the Sun, the son of Aditi (the celestial mother).
- **Om Savitre Namaha** - Salutations to Savitar, the Sun, who brings life and prosperity.
- **Om Arkaya Namaha** - Salutations to the one who is the source of all light and energy.
- **Om Bhaskaraaya Namaha** - Salutations to the Sun, who dispels darkness and illuminates the world.

9.3. **NEED OF SURYANAMAKARAM:**

- **Full-Body Workout**: Surya Namaskar is a series of 12 physical postures that work every part of the body, providing a comprehensive workout. It helps improve flexibility, strength, and posture while toning the muscles, particularly in the back, legs, arms, and core.
- **Improves Circulation**: The continuous flow of movements in Surya Namaskar helps stimulate blood circulation throughout the body, which can help rejuvenate tissues and improve energy levels.
- **Detoxification**: The practice of alternating between stretching and contracting various muscle groups helps to flush out toxins from the body. The deep breathing involved also aids in improving the oxygen supply to the organs, further supporting the body's natural detox processes.
- **Mental Clarity and Focus**: Surya Namaskar involves synchronization of breath with movement, which helps calm the mind and improve focus. This practice encourages mindfulness, making it easier to concentrate and reduce stress and anxiety.
- **Boosts Digestion**: The sequence of postures in Surya Namaskar promotes better digestion by massaging and stimulating the abdominal organs, which helps enhance metabolic functions.

9.4. **BENEFITS OF SURYANAMSKARAM:**

- I**mproves Flexibility**: The series of postures in Surya Namaskar gently stretch the muscles, helping to improve flexibility, particularly in the spine, hamstrings, and shoulders.
- **Strengthens Muscles**: It engages multiple muscle groups, toning and strengthening the body, particularly in the core, legs, arms, and back.
- **Boosts Circulation**: The flow of movements helps improve blood circulation throughout the body, promoting the delivery of oxygen and nutrients to tissues and removing waste products.
- **Enhances Digestion**: The stretching and twisting motions in Surya Namaskar stimulate the abdominal organs, aiding in better digestion and metabolism.
- **Promotes Mental Clarity**: The synchronization of breath with movement calms the mind, helping to reduce stress and anxiety. It also improves focus and concentration, contributing to mental clarity.



Fig.4.Suryanamskaram

9.5. **12 Asanas in Surya Namaskar**

Here's a breakdown of the **12 asanas** in Surya Namaskar with descriptions:

Pranamasana (Prayer Pose)

- **Description**: Stand upright with your feet together and palms in front of your chest, joined in a prayer position (Anjali Mudra). Close your eyes and breathe deeply, grounding yourself.

Hastauttanasana (Raised Arms Pose)

- **Description**: From the prayer pose, inhale and raise your arms overhead, arching your back slightly to stretch the body upward. Your palms should face each other or touch.

Hastapadasana (Hand to Foot Pose)

- **Description**: Exhale and bend forward from the hips, bringing your palms to the floor beside your feet (or as close as you can comfortably reach). Keep your legs straight and head towards the knees.

Ashwa Sanchalanasana (Equestrian Pose)

- **Description**: Inhale and step your right leg back, placing your right knee on the floor and your left knee bent at a right angle. Raise your arms above your head, palms facing each other.

Dandasana (Stick Pose)

- **Description**: From Ashwa Sanchalanasana, step your left leg back to meet the right, bringing your body into a plank position with your arms straight, shoulders aligned with wrists, and body in a straight line.

Ashtanga Namaskara (Salute with Eight Parts)

- **Description**: Exhale and lower your body to the ground by bending your elbows, bringing your chest, chin, knees, and feet to the floor. Your hands should stay on the ground, elbows bent, and body supported by eight parts (hands, knees, chest, chin, and feet).

Bhujangasana (Cobra Pose)

- **Description**: Inhale and slide forward, lifting your chest off the ground by straightening your arms. Keep your elbows slightly bent and engage your back muscles as you lift the torso.

Adho Mukha Svanasana (Downward-Facing Dog)

- **Description**: Exhale and lift your hips toward the ceiling, bringing your body into an inverted "V" shape. Keep your hands shoulder-width apart and feet hip-width apart, pressing your heels toward the ground.

Ashwa Sanchalanasana (Equestrian Pose) – Other Side

- **Description**: Inhale and bring your right foot forward between your hands, placing your left knee on the ground. Raise your arms overhead and stretch your chest.

Hastapadasana (Hand to Foot Pose) – Other Side

- **Description**: Exhale and step your left foot forward between your hands, bringing your feet together. Bend forward, placing your palms on the floor next to your feet, and bring your head toward your knees.

Hastauttanasana (Raised Arms Pose) – Other Side

- **Description**: Inhale and rise up from the forward bend, reaching your arms overhead and arching your back slightly.

Pranamasana (Prayer Pose) – Return to Start

- **Description**: Exhale and bring your palms together in front of your chest, returning to the prayer position. Close your eyes, breathe deeply, and center yourself.

10. ASANA:

An **asana** is a physical posture or pose practiced in yoga. The word comes from the Sanskrit root "as," which means "to sit" or "to be steady." In the context of yoga, asanas are designed to promote physical health, flexibility, and strength while also cultivating mental focus and relaxation. Each asana has specific benefits for the body and mind, helping to improve balance, posture, and overall well-being. The practice of asanas is a key component of yoga and is often paired with breath control (pranayama) and meditation for a holistic approach to health and wellness.

10.1. **BENEFITS OF ASANA:**

- **Improves Breathing**: Asanas help open up the chest and lungs, allowing for better lung capacity and deeper breathing, which contributes to improved overall respiratory health.
- **Promotes Mind-Body Awareness**: Asanas encourage mindfulness and presence, fostering a deeper connection between the body and mind. This awareness can enhance mental clarity and emotional stability.
- **Enhances Energy and Vitality**: Asanas energize the body by improving circulation, stimulating the nervous system, and helping to release tension, leaving you feeling more vibrant and alive.

10.2. TYPES OF ASANAS:

10.2.1. **PADMASANA:**



Fig.5.Padmasana

➢ **Meaning by its name:**

- **Padma** means "lotus" in Sanskrit, and **asana** means "pose" or "posture."
- The pose is named after the lotus flower, symbolizing purity, enlightenment, and beauty in many spiritual traditions. In this pose, the legs are crossed in a way that resembles a blooming lotus, and the posture is thought to aid in cultivating inner peace and spiritual growth.

➢ **Technique:**

- **Start in a seated position**: Sit on the floor with your legs extended straight in front of you.
- **Cross your right leg**: Bend your right knee and place your right foot on the left thigh, with the sole of your foot facing upward.
- **Cross your left leg**: Bend your left knee and place your left foot on your right thigh in the same manner, with the sole of your foot facing upward.

- **Align your spine**: Sit upright with your spine straight, shoulders relaxed, and chest open.
- **Place your hands**: Rest your hands on your knees, with your palms facing upward in a mudra (such as Gyan mudra, where the tips of the index finger and thumb touch).
- **Focus on your breath**: Close your eyes gently and focus on your breath. Breathe deeply and calmly, maintaining a steady, relaxed rhythm

➢ **Precautionary Measures:**

- **Avoid if you have knee or hip problems**: This pose requires a certain level of flexibility in the knees and hips. If you have any knee or hip issues, it's best to avoid Padmasana or practice a modified version (like Sukhasana or Ardha Padmasana).
- **Don't force the pose**: Do not force your legs into position if they do not naturally fit. Overstretching can lead to injury. It's important to respect your body's limits.
- **Use props if needed**: If you find it difficult to sit with your legs in the full lotus position, you can use blankets or cushions under your hips to elevate them and make the pose more comfortable.
- **Warm up first**: Always perform gentle stretches to warm up the hips, knees, and ankles before attempting Padmasana, especially if you are new to the pose.

➢ **Benefits:**

- **Improves Flexibility**: Regular practice helps improve flexibility in the hips, knees, and ankles, especially as the pose stretches these areas.
- **Enhances Concentration**: Padmasana is widely used for meditation. It helps create a stable and grounded foundation, allowing for deep concentration and focus, making it easier to enter a meditative state.

10.2.2. VAJRASANA



Fig.6.Vajrasana

➢ **Meaning by Name:**

- **Vajra** means "thunderbolt" or "diamond" in Sanskrit. It symbolizes strength, stability, and indestructibility.
- **Asana** means "pose" or "posture."
- Vajrasana is named after the thunderbolt weapon of Lord Indra, symbolizing its ability to bring strength and firmness.

➢ **Technique:**

- **Start in a kneeling position**: Begin by kneeling on the floor with your knees together and feet pointing straight back.
- **Sit back on your heels**: Slowly sit down on your heels, so that your buttocks rest comfortably on the backs of your thighs or on the heels. Ensure that your spine is straight, shoulders are relaxed, and your chest is open.

- **Place your hands**: Rest your hands on your knees with the palms facing downward or upward in a mudra (e.g., Gyan mudra where the tips of your index fingers and thumbs touch).
- **Align your body**: Keep your back straight, head in line with the spine, and your chin slightly tucked in.
- **Breathe deeply**: Focus on your breath. Breathe deeply and evenly, maintaining a calm and steady rhythm.
- **Hold the position**: Stay in this position for a comfortable duration, gradually increasing the time as you practice.

➢ Precautionary Measures:

- **Avoid if you have knee, ankle, or hip problems**: Vajrasana puts pressure on the knees, so if you have knee or ankle issues, avoid this pose or use props to make it more comfortable.
- **Practice gently**: If you're new to this pose, don't force your body into it. It may take some time to build comfort and flexibility.
- **Use a cushion or blanket**: If sitting directly on the heels feels uncomfortable, place a cushion or folded blanket under your buttocks or knees for extra support.
- **Check your posture**: Ensure your spine remains straight throughout the pose, as slouching can lead to discomfort or strain.
- **Avoid if you have severe back issues**: Those with back or spinal problems should approach Vajrasana with caution, as sitting for extended periods in this position may cause strain.

➢ **Benefits:**

- **Improves Digestion**: Vajrasana is highly beneficial for digestion. Sitting in this pose after meals helps improve digestive function by aiding the movement of food through the digestive tract and stimulating the digestive organs.
- **Strengthens the Lower Body**: The pose tones and strengthens the thighs, calves, and ankles, providing stability to the lower body.

- **Enhances Posture**: Vajrasana helps in maintaining an erect posture, strengthening the back muscles and improving spinal alignment.

10.2.3. **VRIKSHASANA**



Fig.7.Vrikshasana

➢ **Meaning by Name:**

- **Vriksha** means "tree" in Sanskrit.
- **Asana** means "pose" or "posture."
- So, **Vrikshasana** translates to "Tree Pose," symbolizing the stability, strength, and rootedness of a tree. The pose encourages balance, focus, and a sense of grounding, like a tree deeply rooted in the earth.

➢ **Technique:**

- **Stand in Tadasana (Mountain Pose)**: Begin by standing upright with your feet together, arms by your sides, and your weight evenly distributed on both feet.
- **Shift weight to one leg**: Gently shift your weight to your left leg, grounding your foot into the floor, and lift your right foot off the ground.

- **Place the right foot**: Bend the right knee and place the sole of your right foot on the inner thigh or calf of the left leg (avoid the knee). Your toes should be pointing downward, and the foot should press firmly into the inner thigh or calf.
- **Bring your hands together**: Once you're balanced, bring your palms together in front of your chest in a prayer position (Anjali Mudra). Alternatively, you can raise your arms overhead with your palms facing each other, keeping your arms straight and shoulders relaxed.
- **Focus and breathe**: Focus on a point in front of you (a drishti) to help maintain your balance. Breathe deeply and evenly, staying centered and grounded.
- **Hold the pose**: Stay in this position for 20-30 seconds or as long as you can maintain balance, then slowly release and repeat on the other side.

- **Vrikshasana** (Tree Pose) is a standing yoga posture that is often practiced for improving balance, concentration, and mental clarity. Here's an overview of Vrikshasana:
- So, **Vrikshasana** translates to "Tree Pose," symbolizing the stability, strength, and rootedness of a tree. The pose encourages balance, focus, and a sense of grounding, like a tree deeply rooted in the earth.

➢ **Precautionary Measures:**

- **Avoid if you have knee or ankle issues**: People with knee or ankle injuries should avoid this pose, or practice with modifications (e.g., using a wall for support).
- **Don't force the foot placement**: If you have difficulty bringing your foot to your thigh, place it on the calf instead. Avoid placing it directly on your knee to prevent strain.
- **Use a wall for support**: If you are new to Vrikshasana and find it hard to balance, practice with a wall or a chair for support until you gain more stability.

➢ **Benefits:**

- **Improves Balance and Coordination**: Vrikshasana enhances your sense of balance and coordination, as it requires focus and stability in the standing leg.
- **Strengthens Legs**: This pose strengthens the standing leg, particularly the calves, thighs, and ankles, and improves lower body endurance.

- **Opens the Hips**: The external rotation of the lifted leg helps open the hips, improving flexibility in the hip joint.

10.2.4. **TRIKONASANA**



Fig.8.Trikonasana

➢ **Meaning by Name:**

- **Trikona** means "triangle" in Sanskrit.
- **Asana** means "pose" or "posture."
- Therefore, Trikonasana translates to "Triangle Pose," named for the shape the body forms in this posture — with the legs and arms creating a triangle.

➢ **Technique:**

- **Start in Tadasana (Mountain Pose)**: Begin by standing with your feet about 3-4 feet apart, depending on your height. Ensure your body is aligned, shoulders relaxed, and arms by your sides.

  - **Turn your feet**: Turn your left foot 90 degrees to the left, so that the toes are pointing outward. At the same time, turn your right foot slightly inward (about 15 degrees). Make sure your heels are aligned.
  - **Extend your arms**: Inhale and extend both arms out to the sides at shoulder height, with the palms facing down.
  - **Bend your body to the left**: Exhale and reach your left hand out over your left leg, keeping your arms straight. Lower your left hand toward your left ankle, shin, or the floor (depending on your flexibility). Keep your right arm extended straight toward the ceiling, forming a straight line from your left hand to your right.
  - **Keep your body in alignment**: As you bend, aim to keep your body in one plane (not leaning forward or backward). Your chest should open toward the ceiling, and your head can be turned to look up at your right hand or straight ahead, depending on your comfort.
  - **Engage your core and legs**: Ensure your legs are strong and straight, and engage your core muscles to avoid collapsing your torso. Keep the weight evenly distributed between both feet.
  - **Hold the position**: Stay in the pose for 20-30 seconds, breathing deeply and evenly. When you're ready, slowly return to the starting position and repeat on the other side.

  ➢ **Precautionary Measures:**

  - **Avoid hyperextension**: Be mindful not to over-stretch or lock your knees. Keep a slight bend in the knees if needed, especially if you feel strain.

  - **Neck alignment**: Keep your neck in a neutral position, whether you choose to look up at your raised hand or forward. Avoid straining your neck by forcing it into an uncomfortable position.

  - **Avoid if you have back or hip problems**: If you have back, hip, or leg injuries, perform this pose with caution. Modify the depth of the stretch and avoid pushing yourself too far.

- **Modify if you have tight hamstrings**: If you have tight hamstrings, avoid going too deep into the pose. You can place your hand on a block or your shin instead of reaching the floor.
- **Pregnancy caution**: Pregnant women should modify the pose by not extending too deeply into the stretch, and should avoid turning the body excessively or twisting it too much.

➢ **Benefits:**

- **Stretches the Legs, Hips, and Spine**: Trikonasana provides a deep stretch to the hamstrings, calves, hips, and lower back, improving flexibility in these areas.
- **Strengthens the Legs and Core**: The pose strengthens the legs, especially the quadriceps, and engages the core muscles, improving stability and balance.
- **Improves Posture**: By opening the chest and aligning the spine, Trikonasana encourages better posture and spinal alignment.
- **Enhances Balance and Coordination**: Balancing on the legs in this pose improves overall coordination and body awareness.
- **Reduces Stress**: Trikonasana is a calming pose that can help reduce stress and anxiety by promoting deep breathing and relaxation.

10.2.5. **BHUJANGASANA**



Fig.9.Bhujangasana

➢ Meaning by Name:

- **Bhujanga** means "cobra" in Sanskrit.
- **Asana** means "pose" or "posture."
- Therefore, **Bhujangasana** translates to "Cobra Pose," named for the shape the body forms in this posture — with the chest lifted and the head and neck extended like the hood of a cobra.

➢ Technique:

- **Start in Prone Position**: Lie flat on your stomach with your legs extended and the tops of your feet pressing into the floor. Place your hands directly under your shoulders with your elbows bent and close to your body.
- **Engage Your Legs**: Press the tops of your feet into the ground and engage your legs, keeping them straight. Your thighs, hips, and the tops of your feet should be in contact with the floor.
- **Lift the Chest**: Inhale and slowly begin to lift your chest off the floor by straightening your arms. Use your back muscles to support the lift, keeping your elbows slightly bent and close to your body.
- **Extend the Spine**: As you lift your chest, arch your back gently, opening up the chest and throat. Press your pubic bone into the floor and keep your legs active.
- **Open the Chest**: Lift your heart toward the ceiling, and allow your shoulders to roll back and away from your ears. Keep your gaze forward or slightly upward, but avoid straining your neck.

- **Breathe and Hold**: Hold the position for 15-30 seconds while breathing deeply. When you are ready to release, exhale and gently lower your chest back down to the floor.
- **Repeat**: You can repeat the pose 2-3 times, gradually increasing the duration of the hold as you become more comfortable.

➢ Precautionary Measures:

- **Avoid excessive backbend**: Do not push your chest off the ground too forcefully or too high, as this could strain the lower back. Keep the backbend gentle and focus on using your back muscles rather than relying too much on your arms.
- **Neck care**: Keep your neck in a neutral position, aligned with the spine. Avoid looking too far upward, as this can strain the neck. Keep your gaze straight ahead or slightly upward without forcing the neck into discomfort.
- **Avoid if you have back problems**: People with back or spinal injuries should approach this pose with caution or avoid it altogether. Always consult a healthcare professional before attempting backbends if you have a history of back issues.

➢ Benefits:

- **Stretches the Spine**: Bhujangasana provides a deep stretch to the spine, improving flexibility and relieving tension in the back.
- **Strengthens the Lower Back**: It strengthens the muscles in the lower back, helping to improve posture and support spinal health.
- **Opens the Chest and Lungs**: This pose opens the chest and expands the lungs, improving lung capacity and helping to improve breathing.

10.2.6. SHALABHASANA



Fig.10.Shalabhasana

➢ Meaning by Name:

- **Shalabha** means "locust" in Sanskrit, representing the shape of the body when the legs and chest are lifted in the pose.
- **Asana** means "pose" or "posture."
- Therefore, Shalabhasana translates to "Locust Pose," named for the shape of the body in this posture, which resembles a locust with its limbs extended.

➢ Technique:

- **Start in Prone Position**: Begin by lying flat on your stomach with your legs extended straight behind you and your arms at your sides, palms facing downward.
- **Engage the Legs**: Press the tops of your feet into the floor and engage your thighs. Keep your legs straight and activate the muscles in your legs and glutes.
- **Lift the Chest and Legs**: Inhale and lift your chest, arms, and legs off the floor simultaneously. Your chest should rise by pressing your forearms or hands into the floor, and your legs should lift without bending at the knees.
- **Extend Your Limbs**: Keep your arms straight and extended at your sides, or you can reach them forward (as in a full variation of the pose). Your legs should be straight and together, lifted from the ground while keeping the pelvis pressing into the floor.

- **Engage the Core and Glutes**: Focus on engaging your core and glutes to maintain the lift. Avoid over-arching your lower back, and instead, use your back muscles to support the lift.

- **Hold the Pose**: Stay in the pose for 15-30 seconds, breathing deeply and evenly. Ensure you maintain engagement in your legs, glutes, and core while keeping the chest lifted.
- **Release**: Slowly lower your chest, arms, and legs back to the floor on an exhale. Rest in **Makarasana** (Crocodile Pose) to relax before repeating the pose.

➢ Precautionary Measures:

- **Avoid if you have back issues**: People with spinal injuries, herniated discs, or lower back problems should avoid this pose, as it can strain the back if not done properly.
- **Don't over-lift the chest**: Avoid over-arching your back by lifting your chest too high. It should be a gentle lift, coming from your back muscles, not just the arms.
- **Knee care**: Keep your knees straight and avoid bending them. Bending the knees can reduce the effectiveness of the pose and strain the lower back.

➢ Benefits:

- **Strengthens the Back**: Shalabhasana strengthens the muscles of the back, particularly the lower back and spine, helping to alleviate back pain and improve posture.
- **Improves Posture**: By strengthening the back and shoulders, the pose helps correct poor posture and encourages spinal alignment.
- **Tones the Glutes and Legs**: The engagement of the legs and glutes in this pose helps tone and strengthen the muscles of the hips, thighs, and buttocks.

10.2.7. UTTHITADVIPADASANA



Fig.11.Utthitadvipadasana

➢ Meaning by Name:

- **Utthita** means "extended" or "raised" in Sanskrit.
- **Dvipada** means "two legs."
- **Asana** means "pose" or "posture."
- **Utthita Dvipadasana** therefore translates to "Extended Two-Legged Pose," which describes the action of extending both legs out while balancing on one leg, similar to a standing pose where one leg is lifted parallel to the floor.

➢ Technique:

- **Start in Tadasana**: Begin by standing in Tadasana with your feet together, arms by your sides, and weight evenly distributed across your feet.
- **Shift weight to one leg**: Transfer your weight onto your left foot, grounding it into the floor while lifting your right leg behind you.
- **Lift the right leg**: Slowly extend your right leg behind you, keeping it straight. Make sure to engage the muscles in the lifted leg and keep your hips level to the floor.
- **Extend the torso**: As your right leg lifts, bring your torso forward, keeping your spine long and aligned. Your body should form a straight line from your head to the lifted leg. Extend your arms forward or keep them at your sides for balance.

- **Find your balance**: Keep your gaze steady on a point in front of you to help with balance. Engage your core and hold the position, maintaining a strong, straight posture.
- **Hold the position**: Hold for 20-30 seconds or longer, breathing deeply and focusing on keeping your lifted leg and torso parallel to the floor.
- **Release and repeat**: Slowly lower your right leg and torso back to the starting position, and repeat the pose on the other side.

➢ Precautionary Measures:

- **Avoid arching the back**: Be mindful of your back. If you arch your back excessively while lifting the leg, it may strain your lower back. Keep your spine straight and engage your core.
- **Knee alignment**: Keep a slight bend in the standing leg if necessary to avoid overstraining the knee. Ensure the standing leg is stable and grounded.
- **Neck alignment**: Keep your neck in a neutral position. Avoid looking upward or straining your neck. Gaze down or slightly forward to help maintain balance.

➢ Benefits:

- **Improves Balance and Stability**: This pose is excellent for improving balance, coordination, and body awareness by training you to balance on one leg while keeping your body aligned.
- **Strengthens the Core**: To maintain the extended position, the core muscles (abdominals and obliques) must engage, strengthening and toning the core.
- **Tones the Legs and Glutes**: The standing leg is actively engaged, helping to strengthen the quadriceps, hamstrings, calves, and glutes.

10.2.8. ARDHAHALASANA



Fig.12.Ardhahalasana

➢ Meaning by Name:

- **Ardha** means "half."
- **Hala** means "plow."
- **Asana** means "pose" or "posture."
- **Ardha Halasana** therefore translates to "Half Plow Pose," named for the position of the body, which resembles the shape of a plow but is a more accessible and gentler version of the full Plow Pose (Halasana).

➢ Technique:

- **Start in Supine Position**: Begin by lying flat on your back in **Savasana** (Corpse Pose), with your arms by your sides, palms facing downward, and your legs straight.
- **Engage Your Core**: Press your lower back into the floor and engage your abdominal muscles.
- **Lift the Legs**: Inhale deeply, and as you exhale, slowly raise your legs to a 90-degree angle from the floor, keeping them straight and together. Your feet should be flexed.
- **Shift the Legs Overhead**: Begin to lower your legs toward the floor behind you, keeping them straight. Only lower them as far as you can comfortably go without straining your lower back.

- **Hold the Position**: Keep your legs straight, and avoid arching your lower back too much. You can keep your arms on the floor, palms facing down for support, or place your hands under your lower back for extra support.
- **Stay in the Pose**: Breathe deeply and hold the position for 20-30 seconds, or longer if comfortable. Keep your neck relaxed and face soft.
- **Release the Pose**: To come out of the pose, slowly bring your legs back to the floor, one vertebra at a time, and relax your body back into **Savasana** to rest.

➢ Precautionary Measures:

- **Avoid if you have neck or back issues**: People with neck, back, or spinal problems, particularly in the cervical or lumbar regions, should avoid this pose or perform it with extra caution. It's essential to keep the back flat and avoid over-arching the spine.
- **Lower back strain**: If you feel any discomfort in your lower back while performing the pose, stop immediately, and try not to go too deep. You can place a prop like a bolster under your hips for extra support.
- **Neck alignment**: Ensure your neck is relaxed and in a neutral position. Avoid turning your head to the side, which can strain the neck.

➢ Benefits:

- **Stretches the Spine**: Ardha Halasana gently stretches the spine, helping to lengthen and relieve tension in the back and neck.
- **Strengthens the Core**: The pose engages the abdominal muscles, strengthening the core, which improves stability and posture.
- **Relieves Tension in the Lower Back**: By stretching and strengthening the muscles in the back and core, this pose helps to alleviate tension and tightness in the lower back.

11.CONCLUSION

In conclusion, yoga offers numerous physical, mental, and emotional benefits. Through regular practice, individuals can improve flexibility, strength, and balance, while also fostering mindfulness and reducing stress. Overall, yoga serves as a holistic approach to enhancing overall well-being, making it a valuable practice for people of all ages and fitness levels.